

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar - Solved Practice Workbook

Standalone workbook. It reproduces the complete practice apparatus of the Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar learning package and can be worked without the teaching sessions. Syllabus, verbatim: *Caste Discrimination : Gandhi and Ambedkar.* - UPSC Philosophy Paper II, Section A, item 10. One social structure and two named thinkers are printed, and the two names are not decoration: the clause is built as a **contest** between rival diagnoses of what reproduces birth-based graded inequality and rival methods for ending it. It owns the mechanism of caste's reproduction, the two thinkers' arguments and methods, their debate in its irreducible form, and the later applications - affirmative action and the caste/class/gender/religion intersections - only insofar as those execute the comparison. Historical chronology and regional sociology of caste belong to **History** and **Sociology**; Gandhian socialism and the development doctrine to **Political Ideologies** and **Development and Social Progress**; full Buddhist doctrine to **Buddhism** in Paper I; complete constitutional case-law and policy design to the Polity and Social Justice areas; the gender doctrine as such to **Gender Discrimination**; recognition and multiculturalism as doctrines to **Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism**; liberty, equality and justice as ideals to **Social and Political Ideals**; and full Marxism to **Political Ideologies** - all routed rather than developed.

Evidence discipline: FACT: doctrine on which the canonical owner and the standard sources converge · ANALYSIS: analytical reconstruction offered for exam use · CAUTION: a contested interpretation or a disputed empirical claim. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper II.

Terminology and citation rule: the English concept leads and the technical term follows immediately in parentheses - *the normative fourfold classification found in Brahmanical texts (varṇa), the lived, locally organised and generally endogamous birth-group (jāti), the institutional order joining birth, marriage closure, ranked status, allocated occupation and restricted association (the caste system), practices imposing extreme exclusion and stigma on designated groups (untouchability), the enforced marriage boundary that carries group membership across generations (endogamy), the rules that moralise distance and make exclusion feel like duty (purity and pollution), the restriction of entry to occupations, association and marriage (social closure), an ascending scale of reverence and a descending scale of contempt in which each stratum has a stake in the order's continuance (graded inequality), the hereditary ranking of workers themselves rather than of tasks (division of labourers), the destruction of the sanctified authority that ranks and separates (annihilation of caste), non-violence as a positive refusal to degrade (ahiṃsā), the disciplined, non-violent contestation of unjust practice (truth-force, satyāgraha), the programme of education, sanitation, common service and village work through which reform is enacted daily (the constructive programme), the diffused public commitment to constitutional norms without which the form of administration can be perverted while the text is untouched (constitutional morality), liberty, equality and fraternity held as a way of life (social democracy), the sense of common associated life among social equals (fraternity), self-rule as both political independence and moral self-government (swarāj), the reconstruction of Buddhism as an ethical-social practice of reason, compassion, equality and fraternity (Navāyāna), the argument that positive measures rectify a transmitted, group-directed exclusion (the compensatory justification), the argument that formal equality from today ratifies an unequal starting line (the distributive justification), the argument that institutions excluding whole social groups lack legitimacy (the representational justification), the argument that reservation breaks a monopoly of social power and publicly repudiates ascribed inferiority (the anti-domination justification), the objection that allocation by ascriptive membership inflicts a fresh injustice on personally innocent individuals (reverse discrimination), the distinction between functional capacity for a role and the examination performance that stands in for it (merit as proxy), and the internal filter that excludes the socially advanced among the beneficiary group (the creamy layer).* Works are cited by author and title only - **B. R. Ambedkar, "Castes in India: Their Mechanism, Genesis and Development" (1916), Annihilation of Caste (1936), Who Were the Shudras?, The Untouchables, States and Minorities** and his Constituent Assembly interventions; **M. K. Gandhi, Hind Swaraj and his writings in Young India and Harijan;** **Valerian Rodrigues (ed.), The Essential Writings of B. R. Ambedkar;** **Eleanor Zelliot's studies of Ambedkar and the Dalit movement;** and **O. P. Gauba, An Introduction to Political Theory.** No page, chapter, edition or verbatim wording is asserted for any of them, and no author is quoted anywhere in this workbook. Eight dated Indian facts appear, each classified before use - **Article 17, a constitutional rule; the Communal Award and the Poona Pact, both of 1932; Ambedkar's conversion to Buddhism in 1956; the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, an enacted penal and protective statute in force from 1990; the Second Backward Classes Commission, appointed 1979 and reporting 1980, which recommends rather than enacts, with government action on its recommendation regarding reservation for Other Backward Classes in central government services following in 1990; Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992), a nine-judge Supreme Court judgment; and the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, an enabling amendment inserting Articles 15(6) and 16(6), upheld by a majority in Janhit Abhiyan v. Union of India* (2022).** WRONG: **No caste name, community, region, State, district, population share, literacy figure, land-holding percentage, atrocity count, survey result or dataset is named anywhere,** no figure or negotiating detail of the Poona Pact beyond the substitution, the primary-election mechanism and the increase in reserved seats is asserted, and **no statute, judgment, commission report or amendment is used as evidence for or against a philosophical thesis.**

What this workbook contains

Component	Count
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full, 2018-2025	9
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6

How to use it

1. Attempt the twenty-four core MCQs without notes, then read every option explanation, including those for the options you rejected. The key sequence is **unpatterned** - each answer was fixed independently - so no cycle can be guessed, and option lengths are matched so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape.
2. Work the eight remedial drills only after the core set. They target Ambedkar reduced to reservation, educate-agitate-organise read as self-help, the Poona Pact narrated rather than interpreted, a constitutional rule or penal statute treated as proof that caste has ended, a judicial holding overstated, an enabling amendment described as creating reservation, convergence allowed to erase structural priority, and a comparison stem answered with two sequential biographies.
3. Attempt each previous-year part under time before reading its solution. **Decide the stem's contest first:** one of the nine owned parts is a mechanism stem, three are method stems, two are comparison stems and three are persistence stems. ANALYSIS: Not one of the nine asks for a history of caste, a description of caste practices or an evaluation of reservation policy standing alone.
4. Write the six original models in full. Two are 10-mark, two 15-mark and two 20-mark, and each sits inside the declared word band - **10 marks about 150 to 220 words, 15 marks about 250 to 330, 20 marks about 330 to 400**. They deliberately cover the conceptual grammar, the division-of-labourers argument, the four dimensions of caste injustice, fraternity within the triad, the village-and-modernity dispute and the justification of affirmative action, because none of those carries a directly owned part in the 2018-2025 cycle.
5. Check every answer against the twenty traps: equating varṇa, jāti, caste and untouchability; a timeless Gandhi; inferring blanket anti-varṇa from anti-untouchability; Ambedkar reduced to untouchability; Ambedkar reduced to reservation; caste reduced to class or occupation; the Poona Pact narrated without autonomy or coercion; "Harijan" treated as uncontested; Article 17 or the 1989 Act read as proof caste ended; Gandhi-as-conscience plus Ambedkar-as-law complementarity; flattening the periodisation; "Harijan" used as the narrator's neutral term; Ambedkar reduced to constitutional drafting; educate-agitate-organise as self-help; the Pact without the representation question; romanticising village or central modernity; collapsing caste into class or adding caste and gender arithmetically; equating oppressed-caste assertion with hereditary supremacy; treating redistribution, recognition and representation as substitutes; and letting convergence erase annihilation and autonomous rights.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated and no cycle such as ABCD - or its reverse - can be used to guess. The set contains exactly eight of each letter, no letter repeats consecutively, no four consecutive answers ascend or descend through the alphabet, and no two-letter alternation is allowed to run. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar* - together with the four contests and the five separations, the four-term grammar of the textual order, the lived birth-group, the caste system and untouchability, the seven-link reproduction engine with its intervention map, the division of labour against the division of labourers, graded inequality as an explanation of durability, caste under

universal franchise with the assertion/supremacy separation, the four dimensions of caste injustice with their gender and class mediation, Gandhi's three-phase periodisation with the residue that survives it, his five-step argument and six-instrument method with its four presuppositions, the four objections with their replies and residues, Ambedkar's identification of endogamy in 1916 with the gender bridge, the five moves of the 1936 argument with the inter-dining/inter-marriage discrimination, caste as ranked separation against cultural plurality, the inseparable triad with fraternity and social democracy, constitutional morality and the argument from social power, the beyond-reservation grid with the Marx comparison, the eight-axis comparison matrix with convergence-without-equivalence, the 1932 representation dispute, and the four justifications of affirmative action with the classified Indian record. The eight remedial drills attack the errors that cost marks every year on this clause: reducing Ambedkar to reservation, reading educate-agitate-organise as self-help, narrating rather than interpreting the Poona Pact, treating a constitutional rule or a penal statute as evidence that caste has ended, overstating a judicial holding, describing an enabling amendment as creating reservation, letting convergence erase structural priority, and answering a comparison stem with two sequential biographies.

MCQ 1. What the printed clause actually owns

A script opens a twenty-mark answer on this clause by writing that caste discrimination is "one of the gravest social evils of Indian society, which both Gandhi and Ambedkar fought against in their own ways". On the account developed in this package, what has that opening cost the answer?

- A. It has cost the script its Indian material, because a general moral opening leaves no natural place for the constitutional and statutory illustrations that this clause expects an answer to classify and deploy.
- B. It has cost the script the dispute, because the clause prints two names in order to set two rival diagnoses against each other, and "in their own ways" converts a disagreement into a difference of style.
- C. It has cost the script its evidence base, because the two thinkers wrote across different decades and an opening that does not date their positions cannot use either of their texts accurately.
- D. It has cost the script nothing analytically, because the paper does print a social evil alongside two reformers, and an answer that treats them in that order has followed the structure the examiner supplied.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: classified Indian instruments can be attached to a general opening as easily as to an analytical one, so nothing about them is lost; what is lost is the argument they were meant to illustrate.
- **B:** Correct: the clause is constructed as a contest between rival diagnoses of what reproduces caste, and "in their own ways" dissolves precisely the disagreement the 2019 and 2025 stems ask to be examined.
- **C:** Incorrect: dating matters for Gandhi's periodisation, but the opening's defect is structural rather than chronological, and a dated opening that still harmonised the two would fail in the same way.
- **D:** Incorrect: sequence is not structure; naming a social evil and two reformers supplies an itinerary, and the examiner is asking which method reaches what reproduces the arrangement.

Examiner trap 1: Treating Gandhi and Ambedkar as complementary contributors to a shared anti-caste cause is the commonest structural failure on this clause, because it makes the adjudication that both twenty-mark stems demand unavailable from the first sentence onward.

MCQ 2. The four terms and their scopes

Which statement correctly reports the relation among the textual fourfold order, the lived birth-group, the caste system and untouchability?

- A. The four terms name four historically successive stages, so an accurate answer traces the movement from a textual scheme through lived groups to a system and finally to its most extreme practices.
- B. The four terms are interchangeable descriptions of a single institution, so a script may use whichever of them the stem happens to employ without any loss of analytical precision at all.
- C. The first two terms are normative and the second two descriptive, so philosophical analysis attaches only to the first pair and the second pair belongs to sociology rather than to this paper.
- D. The four terms have four different scopes, and holding them apart is what makes it possible to state Gandhi's earlier position and Ambedkar's target accurately rather than approximately.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the owner explicitly warns against describing caste as a single unchanged institution across history, and a stage account asserts a chronology this owner does not supply or endorse.
- **B:** Incorrect: interchangeability is exactly the flattening wreck, and it makes "Gandhi opposed untouchability" silently convert into "Gandhi opposed caste", which is false of his earlier position.
- **C:** Incorrect: all four terms are used analytically here, and untouchability in particular carries a philosophical claim - that it intensifies rather than exhausts the ranking principle.
- **D:** Correct: the separation is a condition of stating either thinker's position, which is why it is the opening move rather than a preliminary courtesy to vocabulary.

Examiner trap 2: Writing "caste means the four varṇas" converts a normative textual classification into a description of society and loses the first marks of any ten-marker, because every later claim about lived groups then rests on a category error.

MCQ 3. What untouchability is, relative to caste

Why does this owner insist that untouchability is a symptom and intensification of caste hierarchy rather than a synonym for it?

- A. Because the ranking principle operates throughout the order, so a rule abolishing the extreme practice can succeed while birth continues to allocate marriage, occupation and standing everywhere else.
- B. Because untouchability was practised only in some regions, so a general account of caste cannot be built on a practice whose distribution across the society was uneven and locally variable in character.
- C. Because Gandhi opposed untouchability while defending an idealised duty-order, so the two must be kept apart in order to make his position internally consistent rather than self-contradictory.
- D. Because the constitutional rule addresses untouchability alone, so an analysis that merged the terms would misstate the scope of the instrument it is using as its Indian illustration.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the intensification reading explains why prohibiting the practice leaves the allocation operating, which is the observation on which Ambedkar's demand for annihilation rests.
- **B:** Incorrect: the owner records wide regional variation among lived groups but asserts no distribution of any particular practice, and no such empirical claim is available here.
- **C:** Incorrect: it is true that the separation clarifies Gandhi's position, but the doctrinal reason is about the ranking principle rather than about rescuing a thinker's consistency.
- **D:** Incorrect: the scope of Article 17 follows from the distinction rather than grounding it, and the owner's point is philosophical rather than a comment on drafting.

Examiner trap 3: Treating untouchability as a synonym for caste makes Ambedkar's insistence on annihilation look like rhetorical excess rather than a doctrinal consequence, and it removes the answer's ability to explain why legal abolition left the structure functioning.

MCQ 4. Why the mechanisms are written as a chain

A candidate answering the 2024 part lists endogamy, hereditary status, occupational closure, ritual rules, religious sanction and economic power as the factors responsible for caste discrimination. What does the chain form add that the list does not?

- A. It adds historical accuracy, because the six factors emerged in a determinate order and an answer that reproduces that order is describing the formation of the system rather than its present operation.
- B. It adds comprehensiveness, because a chain can accommodate the seventh factor of political mobilisation, whereas a list of six omits the effect of universal franchise on the operation of caste.
- C. It adds explanatory power, because each link makes the next possible, so the system's characteristic property becomes visible: the reform of any single component is absorbed by the rest.
- D. It adds evaluative content, because a chain establishes which factor is most responsible, and a stem asking for the main factors is asking the candidate to rank them by causal weight.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the chain is a reproduction account rather than a genesis account, and asserting an order of historical emergence takes on a burden this owner declines to carry.
- **B:** Incorrect: a list can be extended to seven items as easily as to six, and the ambivalence of mobilisation is a separate point about its normative status.
- **C:** Correct: absorption of single-component reform is the property the chain exposes, and it is what converts a factors question from an inventory into an argument.
- **D:** Incorrect: the chain identifies intervention points rather than a ranking, and the owner nowhere assigns comparative causal weight among the mechanisms.

Examiner trap 4: Answering the factors stem with six accurate nouns in a row supplies a description where an explanation was required, and it leaves the answer unable to say why reform of any one factor has repeatedly failed to reach the others.

MCQ 5. Division of labour and division of labourers

What exactly does Ambedkar's distinction between a division of labour and a division of labourers establish?

- A. That caste is economically inefficient, since fixing occupation by birth wastes talent, and that an efficient society would therefore have dismantled the arrangement long before any moral argument arose.
- B. That caste is a form of class exploitation, since the allocation of work by birth is a device for securing cheap labour, and that a material analysis is therefore sufficient to explain it.
- C. That occupational specialisation is objectionable, since a society assigning different work to different people has thereby ranked them by the value attached to that work.
- D. That caste allocates and ranks persons rather than tasks, so that the worker's hereditary worth - and not merely the distribution of work - is what the arrangement is fixing.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: inefficiency is a subsidiary move inside the reply, not the establishment of the distinction, and the owner's claim concerns the ranking of persons rather than the wastage of talent.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is precisely the reduction the owner forbids; caste interacts with class without being reducible to it, and a material analysis leaves the sacred sanction unexplained.

- **C:** Incorrect: the target is ascription rather than specialisation, and a script that condemns the division of work has misidentified what the distinction is designed to isolate.
- **D:** Correct: the distinction separates the allocation of tasks from the ranking of the persons who perform them, which is what no functional account of work requires or explains.

Examiner trap 5: Sliding from the division-of-labourers argument into an account of economic exploitation reduces caste to class, which this owner explicitly forbids, and it forfeits the ranking claim that the distinction exists to establish.

MCQ 6. The limit of the labour argument

The labour argument defeats the functional-efficiency defence, and this owner nevertheless insists that it must be paired with something else. Why?

- A. Because the argument depends on a contested claim about aptitude, and pairing it with graded inequality supplies the empirical support that the aptitude premise cannot independently provide by itself.
- B. Because the argument does not reach the ritual and purity dimension, so used alone it yields an economic reading that cannot explain why exclusion is experienced by its practitioners as duty.
- C. Because the argument applies only to occupations that are hereditary in fact, and pairing it with endogamy extends its reach to groups whose members have already left inherited work.
- D. Because the argument was made in 1936 rather than in 1916, and pairing it with the earlier mechanism paper is what establishes the continuity between Ambedkar's two principal texts.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the aptitude point is a move inside the reply and requires no empirical support beyond the observation that birth allocation ignores aptitude by construction.
- **B:** Correct: the owner states the limit explicitly, and the sacred sanction is what makes the exclusion feel obligatory rather than merely disadvantageous to those who practise it.
- **C:** Incorrect: the pairing recommended is with graded inequality and the sanction, and the endogamy point addresses reproduction rather than the reach of the labour argument.
- **D:** Incorrect: the dates are accurate but irrelevant to the limit, which concerns the dimension of caste the labour argument leaves untouched rather than the chronology of the texts.

Examiner trap 6: Using the division-of-labourers argument as a complete account of caste wins the argument against the functionalist and loses the analysis of the system, because the moralisation of distance is left entirely unexplained.

MCQ 7. Graded inequality and the failure of solidarity

Why does this owner treat graded inequality as an explanation of caste's durability rather than as a description of its shape?

- A. Because a graded order contains more groups than a binary one, and the sheer number of separately organised groups makes coordinated action logistically harder to arrange and to sustain.
- B. Because a graded order is legitimated by sacred authority, and an arrangement presented as obligatory is much harder to resist than one presented as merely conventional or economically convenient to keep.
- C. Because each level is subordinated above and superior below, so combination with those beneath costs a relative standing, and solidarity is therefore against an interest the order itself manufactures.
- D. Because the top of a graded order is smaller than the top of a binary one, so the dominant group can concentrate its resources on defending a narrower and more easily defended boundary.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the number of groups is a feature of the arrangement, but the owner's explanation is about manufactured interest rather than about the logistics of coordination.
- **B:** Incorrect: sacred sanction is a separate mechanism in the chain, and it explains obligation rather than the specific failure of combination among subordinated groups.
- **C:** Correct: the ascending scale of reverence and descending scale of contempt gives almost every stratum a stake in the order's continuance, which is why the oppressed do not unite.
- **D:** Incorrect: no claim about the relative size of strata is made or needed, and the explanation concerns the position of subordinated groups rather than the strategy of dominant ones.

Examiner trap 7: Importing a two-class model into the analysis destroys exactly the feature that explains durability, because a binary hierarchy predicts the combination of the subordinated that a graded one explains the absence of.

MCQ 8. Universal franchise and the body politic

What is the accurate assessment of what universal franchise does to caste?

- A. It converts subordinated populations into constituencies with voice and bargaining power while leaving marriage closure, ritual rank and material dependence - which operate in the household - untouched.
- B. It dissolves caste as a political force, because equal weight at the ballot removes the asymmetry of power on which the whole hierarchy had always depended, leaving only residual attitudes to erode slowly.
- C. It entrenches caste more deeply than before, because electoral competition converts every birth-group into a permanent bloc and thereby gives the hierarchy a new institutional foundation.
- D. It leaves caste unchanged, because voting is a formal procedure whose effects are confined to the selection of representatives and cannot reach any social relation of any kind.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the owner records both the genuine transformation and its limits, and the citizen-against-household contrast explains why equal votes and unequal worth coexist.
- **B:** Incorrect: the owner explicitly records the persistence of caste through candidate selection, patronage, symbolic mobilisation and social blocs, so dissolution is not available.
- **C:** Incorrect: this collapses the assertion/supremacy separation and ends by condemning the democratic self-organisation of the oppressed as an entrenchment of hierarchy.
- **D:** Incorrect: denying the change makes Ambedkar's own insistence on representation unintelligible, since he claims the franchise precisely as an instrument of emancipation.

Examiner trap 8: Concluding that the franchise made no difference is as damaging as concluding that it dissolved caste, because both verdicts remove the tension that the 2022 body-politic stem is built to examine.

MCQ 9. Assertion, supremacy and electoral mobilisation

How should a candidate handle the normative status of caste-based political mobilisation?

- A. All caste mobilisation should be condemned equally, because the introduction of ascriptive identity into public decision-making is objectionable irrespective of which group is doing the introducing.
- B. All caste mobilisation by subordinated groups should be endorsed, because any organisation of the oppressed enlarges their voice and therefore advances the equality the clause is concerned with.
- C. Assertion seeking equality is defensible and supremacy seeking inherited privilege is not, while ordinary mobilisation contains both and must be judged by its programme and effect.
- D. The question is empirical rather than normative, so a philosophical answer should describe the observed patterns of electoral behaviour and decline to evaluate any of them at all.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: blanket condemnation erases the owner's explicit separation and ends by criticising subordinated groups for using the only instrument the franchise gave them.
- **B:** Incorrect: blanket endorsement ignores the conceded residues of elite capture and permanent bloc politics, which the owner names as genuine risks within assertion itself.
- **C:** Correct: the three-way separation is the owner's own, and judging by programme and effect is what allows an answer to adjudicate rather than to celebrate or denounce.
- **D:** Incorrect: the stem asks what role caste plays in the body politic, which is a normative question, and refusing to evaluate abandons the analysis that earns the marks.

Examiner trap 9: Equating oppressed-caste identity assertion with the defence of hereditary supremacy is a listed trap on this clause, and it converts a democratic claim for equal standing into the very hierarchy it opposes.

MCQ 10. The four dimensions of caste injustice

What follows from separating redistribution, recognition, representation and religion as four dimensions of caste injustice?

- A. That the four can be ranked in order of urgency, so an answer should establish which of them must be addressed first before proposing any remedy for the others in sequence.
- B. That only redistribution and representation are properly political, so recognition and religion belong to social analysis and lie outside the scope of a political-philosophical treatment.
- C. That the four are aspects of a single relation of power, so a remedy addressing any one of them will necessarily produce corresponding effects across the remaining three dimensions.
- D. That a remedy answering one dimension can leave the other three intact, which is why identity without redistribution and redistribution without recognition are both nameable failures.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the owner records entanglement without establishing priority, and reading a ranking out of the grid asserts more than the source supports.
- **B:** Incorrect: recognition and religion are fully inside this clause, since stigma and sacred sanction are two of the mechanisms the two thinkers most directly dispute.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is precisely what the failure modes deny; the grid earns its keep by predicting that success in one dimension can coexist with failure in the others.
- **D:** Correct: the failure modes are the analytical yield of the separation, and naming them is what converts a taxonomy into an evaluative instrument.

Examiner trap 10: Treating redistribution, recognition and representation as substitutes for one another is a listed trap, and it removes the answer's ability to say what a proposed remedy will and will not achieve.

MCQ 11. Caste with class and with gender

Which formulation states this owner's position on the relation of caste to class and to gender?

- A. Caste is a cultural superstructure resting on class relations, while gender inequality is a further superstructural effect, so a material analysis of ownership explains both without remainder.
- B. Caste interacts with control of land, labour and education without being reducible to class, and endogamy makes the regulation of women's marriage internal to caste's own reproduction.
- C. Caste, class and gender are three independent hierarchies that intersect only contingently, so analysis of any one of them may proceed without reference to how the others operate.
- D. Caste and gender are jointly structured while class is unrelated, since the allocation of work by birth concerns social status alone and has no bearing on material holdings or dependence.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the reduction of caste to class that the owner forbids, and it cannot explain the sacred sanction or the ranking of persons prior to any economic relation.
- **B:** Correct: interaction without reduction is the owner's formulation for class, and the 1916 mechanism makes the control of marriage internal rather than adjacent to caste.
- **C:** Incorrect: independence is denied for gender in particular, since endogamy is the reproduction mechanism and it operates through the regulation of marriage.
- **D:** Incorrect: the owner records that caste interacts with control of land, labour and education, so severing it from material holdings misstates half the position.

Examiner trap 11: Adding caste and gender arithmetically - treating a Dalit woman's position as caste disadvantage plus gender disadvantage - is analytically wrong here, because endogamy makes the two jointly structured at the mechanism itself.

MCQ 12. Periodising Gandhi

Why is the periodisation of Gandhi's position treated as the single most reliable mark-getter on this clause?

- A. Because it establishes what was held when, which is a precondition of evaluating the position at all, and it locates the exact point at which the Ambedkarite objection engages.
- B. Because it demonstrates that Gandhi's later position superseded his earlier one, which allows a script to defend him against the standard criticisms without conceding any liability.
- C. Because it supplies dates for particular formulations, and an answer attaching a year to each stage of the trajectory shows the textual precision examiners reward.
- D. Because it shows that Gandhi's views changed under political pressure, which explains the 1932 dispute as an episode in a longer sequence of tactical rather than doctrinal shifts.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: accuracy about the position is the precondition of assessment, and the periodisation shows that the objection bites on birth allocation rather than on untouchability.
- **B:** Incorrect: the owner requires the residue to be stated with the trajectory; using periodisation as a defence produces apologetics, which the owner names as a failure.
- **C:** Incorrect: the owner reconstructs a trajectory without dating individual formulations, and inventing chronological precision is an unsupported factual claim.
- **D:** Incorrect: no claim about tactical motivation is made here, and attributing motives to the shift substitutes psychology for the doctrinal analysis the stem requires.

Examiner trap 12: Flattening Gandhi into one timeless position makes a "critically evaluate" stem unanswerable, because a critical evaluation must first identify which of his positions is being evaluated.

MCQ 13. The residue in Gandhi's earlier position

What exactly is the theoretical liability that Gandhi's later trajectory does not cancel?

- A. That he used the term "Harijan," which many Dalit thinkers rejected as paternalistic, and that no later change of vocabulary can retrospectively remove the objection to the original coinage.
- B. That he opposed separate electorates in 1932, and that his later support for inter-caste marriage cannot alter the constitutional arrangement that the resulting compromise put in place.
- C. That he relied on a metaphysical premise about the unity of life, and that any argument resting on a contested cosmology is unavailable to those who do not share the cosmology.
- D. That an idealised hereditary duty-order can continue to allocate by birth after explicit ranking has been denied, so the arrangement reproduces closure without asserting superiority.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the terminological point is real and separately recorded, but the owner identifies the residue as the survival of birth allocation rather than as a question of vocabulary.
- **B:** Incorrect: the 1932 dispute is a distinct disagreement about representation, and it is not what the owner names as the liability of the earlier hereditary-duty arguments.
- **C:** Incorrect: the metaphysical premise is a feature of the argument against untouchability and is answered separately; it is not the residue attaching to the duty-order.
- **D:** Correct: the owner states that an idealised duty-order can preserve birth allocation even after ranking is denied, and that this remains a genuine theoretical liability.

Examiner trap 13: Inferring from Gandhi's opposition to untouchability that he opposed every form of the hereditary duty-order from the outset is a listed trap, and it removes the liability on which the critical evaluation turns.

MCQ 14. The distinctive step in Gandhi's argument

Which step in Gandhi's five-step argument against untouchability does most to distinguish his position from a straightforward harm-to-victims argument?

- A. The first, that all life participates in a moral-spiritual unity, since it supplies a premise about equal worth that no purely secular account of harm to victims could generate on its own.
- B. The fifth, that legal prohibition is necessary but insufficient, since it identifies a limit on law that a harm-based argument would not accept and that Ambedkar disputes directly.
- C. The third, that inherited exclusion corrupts both the excluded and the conscience of the excluding community, since the two-way harm is what grounds the demand for expiation.
- D. The fourth, that reform must involve repentance by the privileged, since it assigns responsibility to the dominant rather than to the victims of the practice being condemned.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the premise supplies the ground of equal worth, but a harm-to-victims argument can also assert equal worth; it is the two-way corruption that is distinctive.
- **B:** Incorrect: the limit on law is important and is disputed, but it concerns the remedy rather than the character of the wrong that the argument identifies.
- **C:** Correct: because the harm runs both ways, the appropriate response is expiation by the community rather than compensation to victims, which is what makes the position distinctive.
- **D:** Incorrect: the assignment of responsibility follows from the third step rather than standing independently, so it is entailed by the distinctive move rather than being it.

Examiner trap 14: Omitting the two-way corruption step makes Gandhi's demand for penance by the privileged look arbitrary, when it is in fact entailed by his account of whom the practice damages.

MCQ 15. Gandhi's method, accurately described

Which description of Gandhi's method survives scrutiny?

- A. Six instruments - self-purification, truth-force, the constructive programme, reinterpretation from within, non-violent persuasion, and trusteeship with economic reform - each with a distinct target.
- B. A single instrument of moral appeal, supplemented by symbolic acts such as temple entry, whose function was to dramatise a message that could not be conveyed by argument alone.
- C. A political strategy of mass mobilisation whose anti-caste content was subordinate to the shifting requirements of the national movement and was quietly adjusted whenever those requirements happened to change.
- D. A legal programme of prohibition and penalty, supported by moral exhortation, in which the constructive programme functioned as an auxiliary to the enforcement of the prohibition.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the six instruments are on record with distinct targets, and the multiplicity is what allows the method to be assessed link by link rather than dismissed as sentiment.
- **B:** Incorrect: the reduction to moral appeal is precisely the misreading that makes the criticism easy and unearned, and it omits trusteeship and the constructive programme entirely.
- **C:** Incorrect: no claim about subordination to national-movement strategy is made here, and attributing one substitutes political motive for the doctrinal content of the method.
- **D:** Incorrect: Gandhi holds prohibition to be necessary and insufficient, so casting the method as a legal programme inverts the relation his fifth step establishes.

Examiner trap 15: Reducing Gandhi's method to "change of heart" makes the structural criticism trivially easy and simultaneously destroys the comparison, because method is the axis on which the two thinkers most sharply diverge.

MCQ 16. The presupposition that carries most weight

Which of Gandhi's four presuppositions supplies the strongest reply to the charge that his method was too slow to be serious?

- A. That religious traditions contain resources for self-criticism, since it establishes that the sanction can be dislodged from within and therefore that the slower route is the only available one.
- B. That means must embody the equal fellowship sought, since it makes the refusal of coercive routes a requirement of the end rather than a failure of resolve about reaching it.
- C. That privileged persons can be morally transformed, since it establishes an empirical possibility without which no timetable for the method could be constructed or defended.
- D. That social unity must not be purchased through coercive hatred, since it identifies a cost of the faster route that any assessment of comparative speed would have to include.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this presupposition concerns the possibility of internal reform rather than the relation between means and ends, and it does not answer a charge about speed.
- **B:** Correct: if the means must embody the fellowship sought, then a faster coercive route is excluded by the character of the end, which converts slowness from a defect into a requirement.
- **C:** Incorrect: it states a possibility rather than a reason, and the charge of slowness is not met by asserting that transformation can eventually occur.
- **D:** Incorrect: it names a cost of the alternative, which is a supporting consideration rather than the principle that makes the refusal of coercion internal to the end.

Examiner trap 16: Assessing Gandhi's method purely by efficacy ignores the means-embody-ends presupposition, and an evaluation that never states what the method was constrained by has not engaged the position it claims to assess.

MCQ 17. The paternalism objection and what survives it

What exactly survives Gandhi's best reply to the paternalism objection?

- A. The objection stands unless oppressed communities possess autonomous voice and leadership, since renaming and speaking on behalf of a group are not transfers of power to it.
- B. The objection is fully answered, since the moral responsibility of oppressors cannot be delegated to their victims and any remedy must therefore begin with the conduct of the dominant.
- C. The objection collapses into the structural one, since paternalism is the form structural insufficiency takes when the reformer belongs to the group being criticised.
- D. The objection is misdirected, since Gandhi's constructive programme involved shared labour rather than distribution of benefits, and shared labour is by its nature a relation among equals.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the owner's precise formulation makes the residue conditional on autonomous voice and leadership, which converts a moral complaint into a testable condition.
- **B:** Incorrect: the reply establishes that responsibility cannot be delegated, which is a real point, and it does not establish that responsibility alone is sufficient.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two objections are separately stated with separate replies and separate residues, and merging them loses the differentiated verdict the evaluation requires.
- **D:** Incorrect: shared labour attacks the ritual rule about polluting work, but it does not by itself transfer voice or leadership, which is what the objection concerns.

Examiner trap 17: Giving an objection weakly so that the reply appears strong earns nothing on this clause, because examiners are specifically alert to replies aimed at caricatures of the Ambedkarite position.

MCQ 18. What the 1916 argument establishes

Which claim does Ambedkar's endogamy argument actually establish, and which does it not?

- A. It establishes the historical origin of the caste system, and it does not establish anything about how the arrangement is maintained once it has come into existence in a society.
- B. It establishes that occupation is irrelevant to caste, and it does not establish anything about the ritual or religious dimensions through which the hierarchy is legitimated.
- C. It establishes the mechanism by which caste reproduces itself across generations, and it does not establish a settled account of how the arrangement historically arose.
- D. It establishes that caste is a form of gender oppression, and it does not establish an account of the hierarchy that would survive removal of that dimension.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this inverts the owner's own guidance, which treats the genesis account as one hypothesis among several and the reproduction mechanism as the load-bearing claim.
- **B:** Incorrect: occupation remains a link in the reproduction chain, and the endogamy argument adds a mechanism rather than removing one from the account.
- **C:** Correct: the owner directs that the mechanism rather than the historical genesis be used as the anchor, precisely because the origin story is disputed.
- **D:** Incorrect: the argument creates a bridge to gender rather than a reduction, and the full gender doctrine is routed to its own owner instead of being developed here.

Examiner trap 18: Asserting the 1916 genesis account as settled history accepts a burden the paper never imposes, and it exposes the whole answer to a historical dispute that the mechanism claim comfortably survives.

MCQ 19. The gender bridge

What is the correct statement of the relation the endogamy argument establishes between caste and gender?

- A. That caste discrimination and gender discrimination are two names for a single hierarchy, so that an analysis of either one is automatically an analysis of the other in a different vocabulary.
- B. That gender inequality is a consequence of caste, so remedies directed at caste will in due course remove the regulation of marriage and sexuality that caste currently requires.
- C. That caste is a subordinate case of patriarchy, so the control of women's marriage is the primary structure and the ranking of birth-groups is one of its historical expressions.
- D. That caste continuity depends on regulating women's marriage and sexuality, so anti-caste and gender analysis are jointly structured rather than separately conducted and then added.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: identity is not claimed; the owner asserts a structural dependence at the mechanism, which is a stronger and narrower claim than equivalence.
- **B:** Incorrect: the direction of dependence is not asserted as one-way in this manner, and the owner does not predict that anti-caste remedies will dissolve the regulation.
- **C:** Incorrect: subordination of caste to patriarchy reverses the owner's claim and would require the full gender doctrine, which is routed elsewhere rather than developed here.
- **D:** Correct: the owner states that caste continuity depends heavily on regulating women's marriage and sexuality, which is why the two analyses must be jointly structured.

Examiner trap 19: Developing the gender doctrine after naming the bridge breaches the ownership fence and displaces Gandhi and Ambedkar, who are what the clause actually prints and what the examiner is marking.

MCQ 20. The target of Annihilation of Caste

What is the target identified in the 1936 argument, and why does the identification matter?

- A. Untouchability in its most extreme forms, because the elimination of the extreme practices was expected to make the remaining ranked distinctions socially and politically unsustainable.
- B. The sanctified authority of rules that rank and separate, because a system resting on legitimated belief absorbs the reform of any single component of its outward practice.
- C. The economic dependence of subordinated groups, because control of land and employment supplies the enforcement without which ritual rules would have no practical effect.
- D. The occupational allocation of labour, because fixing work by birth is the point at which the hierarchy becomes materially consequential rather than merely ceremonial in character.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: reform limited to untouchability is precisely what the 1936 argument rejects as insufficient, so this reverses the text's central claim.
- **B:** Correct: the first move identifies belief in sacred authority as what sustains the system, and the second draws the consequence that isolated reforms leave it intact.
- **C:** Incorrect: economic dependence is a link in the chain and appears in the fifth move as material relations, but it is not identified as the sustaining sanction.
- **D:** Incorrect: occupational allocation is a mechanism the sanction legitimates, and treating it as the target loses the explanation of why reform is absorbed.

Examiner trap 20: Treating annihilation as a slogan for removing caste feeling loses both halves of the 2023 stem, since the social significance is the marriage circle and association and the political significance is the sanction and representation.

MCQ 21. Inter-dining and inter-caste marriage

Why does the 1936 argument treat inter-dining as insufficient while treating inter-caste marriage as decisive?

- A. Because inter-dining was already widely practised while inter-caste marriage was not, so only the second represented a real departure from the prevailing social conventions of the time.
- B. Because inter-dining is a private act and marriage is a public one, so only the second attracts the social recognition without which a reform cannot alter a community's norms.
- C. Because a shared meal leaves the marriage circle closed, whereas marriage across the boundary attacks endogamy directly and creates the social kinship that makes two groups one.
- D. Because inter-dining concerns ritual purity while marriage concerns property, so only the second reaches the material relations that the fifth move of the argument identifies.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no claim about the prevalence of either practice is made here, and the argument's force is structural rather than a comparison of how unusual each act was.
- **B:** Incorrect: the public/private contrast is not the owner's ground, and a publicly performed shared meal would still leave the reproduction mechanism untouched.
- **C:** Correct: the discrimination follows directly from the 1916 identification of endogamy, and social kinship is what dissolves the boundary rather than merely crossing it.
- **D:** Incorrect: property is not the stated ground of the distinction, and inter-dining does concern more than purity while marriage concerns more than property.

Examiner trap 21: Presenting inter-caste marriage as a symbolic gesture of equality removes the argument's connection to the 1916 mechanism and leaves the 1936 proposals looking like an unordered list.

MCQ 22. Caste against cultural plurality

How does this owner prevent an argument against caste from becoming an argument against cultural difference?

- A. By a two-part test: whether the difference is organised as a rank, and whether association across the boundary is free - plurality passes both and caste fails both of them.
- B. By confining the argument to untouchability, since the extreme practices can be condemned without raising any question about the legitimacy of ordinary group distinctions.
- C. By treating cultural difference as valuable only where it is voluntarily chosen, so that inherited group membership is objectionable and elective group membership is not.
- D. By distinguishing religious from cultural difference, since the objection attaches to sacred sanction and leaves entirely untouched any difference that lacks religious legitimation.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the owner separates plurality as interaction among equal groups from caste as ranked separation, and the two tests are ranking and freedom of association.
- **B:** Incorrect: confining the argument to untouchability abandons Ambedkar's target and reinstates precisely the limited reform that the 1936 argument rejects.
- **C:** Incorrect: the voluntariness criterion is not the owner's, and it would condemn many unranked inherited affiliations that the plurality/caste distinction protects.
- **D:** Incorrect: sacred sanction is one mechanism among several, and a ranked separation enforced by dependence alone would fail the test without any religious legitimation.

Examiner trap 22: Reading "anti-national" as an accusation of disloyalty turns a structural claim about the conditions of common public life into a slur, and it makes the argument look partisan rather than analytical.

MCQ 23. The triad and the place of fraternity

Which statement captures the role of fraternity in Ambedkar's triad?

- A. It is the emotional supplement to liberty and equality, valuable because institutions function better where citizens feel warmth towards one another than where they do not.
- B. It is the social basis of democracy - common associated life among social equals supported by rights - and the element that liberty and equality both depend upon and cannot produce.
- C. It is a residual ideal to be pursued once liberty and equality have been secured, since a society cannot cultivate common feeling while its members remain unequal in status.
- D. It is a substitute for enforceable rights, since a society whose members regard one another as equals has no further need of the institutions designed to protect them from each other.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the sentimental reading is the one the owner explicitly blocks, and warmth is neither what fraternity names nor what makes the triad inseparable.
- **B:** Correct: fraternity names relations among social equals supported by rights and institutions, and both other terms fail without the disposition it supplies.
- **C:** Incorrect: sequencing reverses the dependency, since liberty and equality are said to lack their social basis in fraternity's absence rather than to precede it.
- **D:** Incorrect: fraternity is supported by rights rather than substituting for them, and treating it as a replacement produces exactly the position Ambedkar rejects.

Examiner trap 23: Listing liberty, equality and fraternity as three parallel ideals states nothing assessable, because the argument consists entirely in the three dependencies that hold between them.

MCQ 24. Constitutional morality, correctly understood

What does Ambedkar's concept of constitutional morality assert?

- A. That constitutional provisions must be interpreted according to the moral convictions prevailing in the society at the time, so that the text remains connected to the community it governs.
- B. That citizens have a moral obligation to obey the constitution, so that legal compliance becomes a duty of conscience rather than a matter of prudential fear of enforcement.
- C. That a constitution should embody moral principles rather than merely procedural rules, so that its text supplies the standards by which ordinary legislation is to be evaluated.
- D. That the form of administration can be perverted without altering the text, so a diffused public commitment to constitutional norms must be cultivated for a safeguard to have effect.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: prevailing social conviction is exactly what constitutional morality is meant to restrain, since inherited social authority is what the concept exists to check.
- **B:** Incorrect: the concept concerns the conditions under which a constitution operates as intended rather than the ground of an individual citizen's obligation to obey.
- **C:** Incorrect: the moral content of the text is a separate question, and the owner's claim concerns the disposition required to sustain the text in practice.
- **D:** Correct: the owner states that the form can be perverted without altering the text, which is why a safeguard is inert without the disposition that sustains it.

Examiner trap 24: Reading constitutional morality as legality or respect for law inverts the concept, because its whole point is that the text can be preserved intact while the practice becomes something else.

Remedial drills - eight errors that cost marks every year

MCQ 25. Ambedkar and reservation

A script answering the 2021 part on Ambedkar's measures for eliminating caste discrimination devotes most of its length to reservation and constitutional drafting. What is the precise defect?

- A. Reservation is a safeguard within a far wider programme and by his own account an insufficient one, so the answer has replaced the doctrine with one of its instruments.
- B. Reservation was not among the measures Ambedkar proposed, so the answer has attributed to him a policy that belongs to the later development of Indian constitutional practice.
- C. Reservation is a policy question rather than a philosophical one, so the answer has crossed into Polity and Social Justice and forfeited the philosophical content of the stem.
- D. Reservation was opposed by Gandhi, so an answer centred on it cannot subsequently run the comparison that the surrounding parts of the paper are constructed to elicit.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: annihilation, endogamy, constitutional morality, social democracy, fraternity, organisation, conversion and economic independence all exceed any quota, which is the owner's most emphatic warning.
- **B:** Incorrect: representation and safeguards are genuinely part of his programme, so the defect is proportion and framing rather than misattribution.
- **C:** Incorrect: reservation is analysed philosophically here through the four justifications, so its presence is legitimate and its dominance is not.
- **D:** Incorrect: Gandhi's position on separate electorates concerns the mechanism of representation, and the defect in the script is independent of any comparison.

Examiner trap 25: Reducing Ambedkar to reservation and constitutional drafting is the single most damaging error on this clause, and the beyond-reservation grid exists precisely to prevent it.

MCQ 26. Educate, agitate, organise

How should the formula educate, agitate, organise be read?

- A. As a sequence of stages, in which education must be completed before agitation begins and agitation before organisation, so that each stage supplies the conditions for the next one.
- B. As a description of Ambedkar's own career, in which scholarship preceded contestation and contestation preceded the building of political and social institutions.
- C. As advice to individuals about self-improvement, in which education produces confidence, agitation produces assertiveness and organisation produces the discipline to sustain both.
- D. As an integrated power programme in which education produces critical self-respect, agitation contests public injustice, and organisation builds autonomous collective power.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the owner reads the three as an integrated programme rather than as ordered stages, and no sequencing claim is made about which must be completed first.
- **B:** Incorrect: a biographical reading substitutes a life for a doctrine, and the formula is offered as a programme of emancipation rather than as a summary of a career.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the self-help misreading the owner explicitly corrects, and it detaches the formula from rights, representation and material independence.
- **D:** Correct: the owner directs that the formula be read as a politics of emancipation and representation rather than as a motivational slogan.

Examiner trap 26: Turning educate-agitate-organise into individual self-help is a listed trap, and it strips a programme for building collective power of the political content that makes it a remedy at all.

MCQ 27. The Poona Pact

What must a script do with the Poona Pact if it is to earn marks on this clause?

- A. Narrate the sequence from the Communal Award through the fast to the agreement, since the episode's chronology is what a "detailed account of the debate" is asking to be supplied.
- B. Establish the number of reserved seats agreed and the operation of the primary-election mechanism, since the concrete terms are what distinguish an informed answer from a vague one.
- C. Interpret the principle at stake - whether a subordinated group requires autonomous voice against a social majority - and state that the compromise was reached under coercive circumstances.
- D. Present the agreement as evidence that the two thinkers were able to reconcile their positions, since a negotiated settlement demonstrates that the disagreement was not finally irreducible.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: narration is the standard failure here; the owner directs that the Pact be interpreted rather than told as a story with a beginning and an end.
- **B:** Incorrect: the owner forbids asserting figures or negotiating detail beyond the substitution, the mechanism and the increase, so this invites an unsupported factual claim.
- **C:** Correct: the representation principle and the coercive context are the two elements the owner requires, and together they supply the philosophical content of the episode.
- **D:** Incorrect: reading the compromise as reconciliation is explicitly blocked, since it was reached under morally and politically coercive circumstances.

Examiner trap 27: Narrating the Poona Pact without the autonomous-representation question or its coercive context is a listed trap, and it converts the deepest disagreement in the clause into an anecdote.

MCQ 28. Article 17 and the 1989 Act

A script cites Article 17 and the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 to show that caste discrimination has been overcome in India. What has gone wrong?

- A. The instruments are wrongly classified, since Article 17 is a statutory provision and the 1989 Act is a constitutional amendment, so their respective legal statuses have been reversed.
- B. Enactment, notification, enforcement and social transformation are four different stages, and the existence of a rule and a statute establishes nothing about the last of them.
- C. The instruments address untouchability and atrocities rather than caste, so a script citing them has changed the subject from the hierarchy to two of its expressions.
- D. The instruments postdate both thinkers, so citing them in an answer about Gandhi and Ambedkar introduces material that neither of them could have taken into account.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the classifications given in the option are inverted, but the script's actual error is inferential rather than a mistake about which instrument is which.
- **B:** Correct: the four-stage caution is the owner's standing rule, and treating a rule or a statute as evidence of social transformation is a listed trap.
- **C:** Incorrect: the scope point is accurate as far as it goes, but a script could cite instruments of exactly the right scope and still commit the same inferential error.
- **D:** Incorrect: dated instruments are used throughout as classified illustration, and their date relative to the thinkers is not what makes the inference fail.

Examiner trap 28: Treating a constitutional rule or a penal statute as evidence that caste discrimination has ended is a listed trap, and it discards the four-stage caution that every Indian paragraph on this clause requires.

MCQ 29. Stating a judicial holding

Which statement about *Indra Sawhney v. Union of India* (1992) stays inside its terms?

- A. It held that reservation may never exceed fifty per cent of available posts in any circumstances, and it established the framework governing every later category of reservation in India.
- B. It held that economic criteria may not be used in any reservation scheme, and it therefore settled in advance the constitutional question later raised by the amendment of 2019.
- C. It held that the creamy layer must be excluded from all reservation benefits including those available to the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, without any exception.
- D. It upheld reservation for Other Backward Classes in central government services under Article 16(4), directed exclusion of the creamy layer, and set an ordinary fifty per cent ceiling.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the ceiling is stated as ordinarily applicable save in extraordinary situations, and no holding about every later category may be attributed to the judgment.
- **B:** Incorrect: nothing about later amendments or later categories may be attributed to it, and the owner explicitly forbids extending the holding in this direction.
- **C:** Incorrect: the direction recorded by the owner concerns the socially advanced among the backward classes, and the extension asserted here exceeds the stated terms.
- **D:** Correct: these are precisely the three holdings the owner records, stated in the owner's own terms and with the ordinary-ceiling qualification intact.

Examiner trap 29: Stating a holding more broadly than its terms is the standard failure when case law enters a Philosophy answer, and it converts a classified illustration into an unsupported legal assertion.

MCQ 30. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019

Which description of the 2019 amendment is accurate?

- A. It is an enabling amendment inserting Articles 15(6) and 16(6), permitting special provision including reservation up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections other than those already covered.
- B. It is a constitutional amendment creating a reservation of ten per cent for economically weaker sections, which is added to the existing total and applies across all educational institutions everywhere.
- C. It is a statutory enactment providing reservation for economically weaker sections in central government services, whose validity was subsequently confirmed by a Supreme Court judgment.
- D. It is a constitutional amendment replacing social and educational backwardness with an economic criterion as the basis of all reservation in education and in public appointments.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: this reproduces the owner's classification exactly - an enabling amendment, the two inserted articles, the ceiling, and the "other than" qualification.
- **B:** Incorrect: describing the amendment as creating reservation directly is explicitly forbidden, and the addition-to-a-fixed-total claim ignores the "other than" clause.
- **C:** Incorrect: it is a constitutional amendment rather than a statute, and the type of an instrument is the first thing this owner requires an answer to state correctly.
- **D:** Incorrect: it operates for classes other than those already covered rather than replacing the existing basis, and the replacement claim misstates its scope entirely.

Examiner trap 30: Describing an enabling amendment as creating reservation destroys the philosophical point that follows from it - that an economic criterion inside a social-and-educational framework reopens the question of what wrong is being remedied.

MCQ 31. Convergence and structural priority

A script concludes a comparison by writing that Gandhi supplied conscience, Ambedkar supplied law, and a just society needs both in equal measure. What is wrong with the conclusion?

- A. It is factually inaccurate, since Gandhi regarded legal prohibition as necessary and Ambedkar regarded fraternity as indispensable, so neither thinker really occupies the position assigned to him.
- B. It divides credit where the stem asked for adjudication, and convergence of ends does not equalise diagnostic adequacy or political power, so structural priority has been silently abandoned.
- C. It omits the Poona Pact, which is the point at which the two positions came into direct conflict and without which no comparison of their views on representation can be complete.
- D. It states a synthesis without stating a method, so the reader is left unable to determine how the two contributions are supposed to be combined in any particular institutional setting.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the factual observation is correct and is one reason the formula is crude, but the decisive defect is the abandonment of adjudication that the stem required.
- **B:** Correct: the owner's control states that convergence identifies common ends without equalising diagnosis or power, and a synthesis is defensible only when conversion serves annihilation.
- **C:** Incorrect: the Pact is important content, but a script could include it in full and still close with the same credit-dividing formula.
- **D:** Incorrect: the absence of an institutional method is a secondary weakness, and supplying one would not repair a conclusion that declines to adjudicate.

Examiner trap 31: Using Gandhi as conscience and Ambedkar as law in a simplistic complementarity is a listed trap, and it lets convergence erase the structural priority of annihilation and autonomous rights.

MCQ 32. Structuring a comparison answer

What is the correct structure for a twenty-mark answer on the debate between Gandhi and Ambedkar?

- A. A chronological account of the relationship between the two thinkers, organised around the episodes in which their positions came into public contact with one another.
- B. An exposition of Gandhi's position followed by an exposition of Ambedkar's, followed by a concluding paragraph identifying the points on which the two accounts differ.
- C. Five or six shared axes, with both thinkers run down each, followed by the convergences, the irreducible disagreements and an explicit adjudication between them.
- D. A thematic treatment of caste organised by mechanism, with the two thinkers introduced wherever their views bear on the mechanism currently under discussion.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a chronology of the relationship narrates rather than compares, and the owner directs that even the 1932 episode be interpreted rather than told.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the two-biography structure the owner identifies as the commonest way to lose marks, and a concluding paragraph does not repair it.
- **C:** Correct: fixing the axes and running both thinkers down each is the owner's prescribed structure, with the adjudication stated rather than implied.

- **D:** Incorrect: a mechanism-led structure is appropriate for a factors stem, but it subordinates the comparison the 2019 and 2025 stems specifically demand.

Examiner trap 32: Answering a comparison stem with two sequential mini-essays underperforms regardless of content, because the disagreement the examiner is marking is never displayed on a shared axis where it can be assessed.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key; UPSC publishes no descriptive model answer for Philosophy Paper II. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers, including the 2018 paper's "It is said that..." construction and its "in the light of M. K. Gandhi", the 2021 paper's hyphenated "caste-discrimination" and its two-part construction, the 2022 paper's "body-politic", the 2024 paper's "main factors responsible", and the 2025 paper's "Present a detailed account of the debate" - all preserved verbatim inside the question lines. The 2018 to 2025 Paper II texts are held locally, and the English wording of every part below follows the repository's verified Socio-Political PYQ ledger. Works are cited by author and title only: **B. R. Ambedkar**, "Castes in India: Their Mechanism, Genesis and Development" (1916), **Annihilation of Caste** (1936), **Who Were the Shudras?**, **The Untouchables, States and Minorities** and his Constituent Assembly interventions; **M. K. Gandhi**, **Hind Swaraj and his writings in Young India** and **Harijan**; **Valerian Rodrigues (ed.)**, **The Essential Writings of B. R. Ambedkar**; **Eleanor Zelliot's** studies of Ambedkar and the Dalit movement; and **O. P. Gauba**, **An Introduction to Political Theory**. **No page, chapter, edition or verbatim wording is asserted for any of them, and no author is quoted anywhere in this package.** *Eight dated Indian facts appear, each classified before use - Article 17, a constitutional rule abolishing untouchability and forbidding its practice; the Communal Award and the Poona Pact, both of 1932; Ambedkar's conversion to Buddhism in 1956; the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, an enacted penal and protective statute in force from 1990; the Second Backward Classes Commission, appointed 1979 and reporting 1980, a body that recommends rather than enacts, with government action on its recommendation regarding reservation for Other Backward Classes in central government services following in 1990; Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992), a nine-judge Supreme Court judgment; and the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, an enabling amendment inserting Articles 15(6) and 16(6), upheld by a majority in Janhit Abhiyan v. Union of India* (2022).* **ANALYSIS:** Interpretive disputes - whether an idealised hereditary duty-order can be purified, whether internal religious reform can dislodge a sanction it also preserves, whether reserved seats in joint electorates produce autonomous or dependent representation, and whether the wrong remedied by affirmative action is deprivation or ascriptive exclusion - are flagged as contested rather than settled. **WRONG: No caste name, community, region, State, district, population share, literacy figure, land-holding percentage, atrocity count, survey result or dataset is named anywhere**, no figure or negotiating detail of the Poona Pact beyond the substitution, the primary-election mechanism and the increase in reserved seats is asserted, and **no statute, judgment, commission report or amendment is used as evidence for or against a philosophical thesis.**

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper II parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands used here are **10 marks - about 150 to 220 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 330 words**, and **20 marks - about 330 to 400 words**. Every solution below sits inside its declared band, and the demand decoding, the "why this earns marks" notes and the "how to improve this answer" notes are teaching apparatus that sit **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage. ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: this clause owns **9 of 112** Socio-Political question-parts in the 2018-2025 corpus, distributed **2018: 1, 2019: 1, 2020: 1, 2021: 1, 2022: 2, 2023: 1, 2024: 1, 2025: 1** - present in every year of the held cycle and the most sustained named Indian reform debate in the section. All nine are solved in full below in ledger order, followed by **six original solved Mains models**, two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks. The internal profile is more instructive than the volume. Three parts are **persistence** stems asking why caste survives equal citizenship (2018 Q1(c), 2020 Q3(a), 2022 Q1(b)); three are **method** stems asking whether reform or annihilation is the right instrument (2021 Q4(a), 2022 Q2(b), 2023 Q3(b)); two are **comparison** stems (2019 Q4(a), 2025 Q2(a)); and one is a **mechanism** stem (2024 Q1(c)). **WRONG: Not one** asks for a history of caste, a description of caste practices, a

survey of anti-caste movements, or an evaluation of reservation policy standing alone.

Solved PYQ 1 · 2018 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: It is said that the traditional hold of caste-based groups on Indian social behaviour has survived all attempts to build alternate identities. Discuss in the light of M. K. Gandhi.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Discuss in the light of X" - the persistence claim must be examined through Gandhi's framework , not merely alongside it
Core issue	Why alternate identities have not displaced caste-based social behaviour
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the mechanism of persistence, Gandhi's diagnosis and method, one limit
Key distinction	Identities of citizenship and nation reach the citizen ; endogamy and ritual rank reach the household
Non-negotiables	Periodise Gandhi; state the residue; assert no data about identity or behaviour

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The persistence claim is largely sound, and Gandhi's framework explains part of it while exposing its own limit.

Why alternate identities have not displaced caste. FACT: Citizenship, nationhood and class address the individual as a public person. Caste operates through **endogamy**, inherited status, allocated occupation and ritual rank - relations located in marriage, kinship and dependence. An identity that reaches the citizen at the ballot need not reach the household at all, so the two can coexist indefinitely.

Gandhi's diagnosis. FACT: For Gandhi the persistence is moral: inherited exclusion corrupts both the excluded and the conscience of those who exclude, so no external identity can dislodge it until conduct changes. Legal prohibition is necessary and cannot generate fellowship. **ANALYSIS:** His remedy is therefore self-purification, truth-force and the constructive programme - shared service, education and daily practice rather than declared belonging.

Periodisation. FACT: He condemned untouchability throughout, defended an idealised hereditary duty-order earlier, and moved later towards opposing birth barriers and supporting inter-caste marriage.

The limit. ANALYSIS: Precisely because an idealised duty-order can allocate by birth after ranking is denied, moral reform can transform sentiment while leaving the marriage circle intact.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Caste survives alternate identities because those identities address the citizen and caste reproduces through the household; Gandhi explains why conduct must change, but only rights and autonomous voice make the change irrevocable.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "Discuss in the light of X" is scored on whether X's framework is **used** to analyse the claim rather than summarised beside it. Scripts that describe caste persistence and then append a paragraph on Gandhi have supplied two topics where one analysis was required. The citizen-against-household contrast is the mark-bearing sentence: it explains the persistence *and* locates exactly where Gandhi's method operates.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: position one line; the persistence mechanism four lines; Gandhi's diagnosis and method four lines; periodisation two lines; limit two lines; verdict two lines. Compression plan if short of time: drop the periodisation sentence to a clause, and keep the citizen/household contrast and the verdict, which are what convert description into analysis.

- **Structure:** position -> why alternate identities miss -> Gandhi's diagnosis -> method -> periodisation -> limit -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the reproduction engine; two-way corruption; law as necessary and insufficient.
- **Evidence:** endogamy, inherited status, ritual rank; self-purification, truth-force, constructive programme.
- **Distinction:** identity addressed to the citizen against a mechanism operating in the household.
- **Criticism:** the residue that an idealised duty-order allocates by birth after ranking is denied.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence noting that Gandhi's constructive programme attacks a specific link - the ritual rule that certain labour pollutes those who perform it - because naming the link converts a general claim about moral reform into a targeted one, and it is the step most scripts omit. If two more lines are available, observe that the persistence claim must not be asserted as a social fact about behaviour, since this owner names no data; state it as the claim the stem supplies and test it analytically. Do **not** import Ambedkar's annihilation argument at length here: the stem asks for the discussion to be conducted in the light of Gandhi, and a comparison answer would be answering the 2025 question instead.

Solved PYQ 2 · 2019 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: Examine whether there is any difference between the views of Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar on the philosophical foundations of secular democracy.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Examine whether there is any difference" - the existence of the difference must be established , not assumed
Core issue	The rival foundations each supplies for secular democracy
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: convergence, the two foundations, the representation test, two objections, verdict
Key distinction	An ethic of coexistence against an institutional test forbidding civic inferiority
Non-negotiables	Convergence stated before difference; the Pact interpreted, not narrated; no figures

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: There is a real and irreducible difference, and it is not a difference of emphasis: they ground secular democracy in different things.

The convergence, stated first. FACT: Both reject civic degradation, affirm equal human worth, hold political freedom without social reform incomplete, and deny that violence can found stable equality. Both also accept that institutions and social conduct must change together, so neither is a purely legal nor a purely moral reformer. An answer that omits this is caricature.

Gandhi's foundation. FACT: Secular fellowship rests on **equal regard for religions**, non-violence and conscience. Religion is not excluded from public life; it is purified from within, and coexistence is secured by a transformed disposition rather than by a boundary drawn around belief. **ANALYSIS:** This supplies an **ethic of coexistence**, and its instruments are self-purification, truth-force and daily shared practice rather than enforceable constraint.

Ambedkar's foundation. FACT: Democracy rests on **constitutional morality**, equal citizenship and freedom from religiously sanctioned hierarchy. Because the form of administration can be perverted without altering the text, a diffused public commitment must sustain it, and institutions must be capable of checking a social majority that regards the hierarchy as sacred. **ANALYSIS:** This supplies an **institutional test**: no religious community may convert internal doctrine into **civic inferiority**.

Where the difference bites. ANALYSIS: The 1932 dispute is the test case. Gandhi feared permanent political separation; Ambedkar feared that joint electorates would leave representatives dependent on dominant-caste votes. The Poona Pact substituted reserved seats in joint electorates with a primary-election mechanism and increased reserved seats - a compromise under coercive circumstances, not a consensus.

Two objections. FACT: Against Gandhi: reinterpretation preserves the authority that sanctifies hierarchy, so a purified tradition may still be the tradition that supplies the sanction. **FACT:** Against Ambedkar: law cannot abolish attitudes - which is his own premise, since constitutional morality exists precisely because texts can be preserved and practice perverted.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Gandhi supplies the disposition secular democracy needs and Ambedkar supplies the constraint without which the disposition is unenforceable; the two are not simply alternatives, since an institutional test requires a public disposition before it can be applied at all. But only the constraint can be institutionally secured against withdrawal, so the foundations differ in kind and in adequacy rather than in emphasis.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "Examine whether there is any difference" invites two failures - asserting agreement to appear balanced, or asserting difference without showing where it does work. The mark-bearing move is to state the convergence honestly and then locate the difference at a point where the two positions give **incompatible answers**: whether a subordinated group requires autonomous electoral voice. That is why 1932 belongs here as interpretation rather than as narrative.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: position one line; convergence three lines; Gandhi's foundation four lines; Ambedkar's foundation five lines; the 1932 test case five lines; two objections three lines; verdict three lines. Compression plan: reduce the objections to one line each before touching the two foundation paragraphs, which carry the answer.

- **Structure:** position -> convergence -> foundation one -> foundation two -> test case -> objections -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** equal regard and conscience; constitutional morality; the civic-inferiority test.
- **Evidence:** the Communal Award and Poona Pact of 1932, interpreted; the form/text distinction.
- **Distinction:** ethic of coexistence against institutional constraint.
- **Criticism:** preserved interpretive authority; the legalism objection answered by his own premise.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence observing that the two foundations are not simply alternatives but stand in a dependency: an institutional test needs a public disposition to be applied at all, which is why Ambedkar's constitutional morality is closer to Gandhi's concern than the standard contrast suggests. That converts the verdict from a ranking into an argument. If a further line is available, note that Gandhi's position is not a rejection of secularism as separation but a different account of what secular fellowship requires, since scripts frequently mistake his religious idiom for opposition to secular democracy. Do **not** expound secularism as a doctrine; it is owned by Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism and is used here only as the axis on which the two thinkers differ.

Solved PYQ 3 · 2020 · Q3(a) · 20 marks

Question: State and examine B.R. Ambedkar's contribution towards social changes in Independent India.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"State and examine" - exposition and assessment; a list of contributions answers only the first verb
Core issue	What his contribution consisted in, and how far it produced social change
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: the programme, the four-stage caution, two limits, verdict
Key distinction	Access to positions against the valuation of persons
Non-negotiables	Do not reduce him to reservation or drafting; classify every instrument by type

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: His contribution is a **programme**, not a set of provisions, and it is assessed by asking which link of caste's reproduction each element reaches.

Rights and remedies. FACT: Because caste is enforced through social power rather than private prejudice - through land, employment, credit, dependence and the threat of violence - victims need remedies independent of dominant goodwill: a benefit that can be withdrawn is not a right. Article 17 abolishes untouchability as a constitutional rule, which is a rule and not a report that the practice has ceased.

Representation. FACT: Political representation enables subordinated groups to speak for themselves rather than be spoken for - the principle at stake in 1932 and the ground of his safeguards.

Constitutional morality. FACT: The form of administration can be perverted without altering the text, so a diffused public commitment must be cultivated. This is why he is not a legalist.

Social democracy. FACT: Liberty, equality and fraternity must be a way of life; political democracy resting on graded social worth is unstable. One person one vote and one vote one value, set against unequal worth, is a contradiction a polity cannot indefinitely bear.

Beyond safeguards. ANALYSIS: Annihilation, endogamy, education, agitation, organisation, conversion in **1956** and state-directed economic independence all exceed any quota. His economic proposals aim at landholding and industry so that dependence on dominant-caste landowners and employers is broken, because political safeguards do not touch economic dependence. **WRONG:** Reducing him to reservation replaces the doctrine with one of its instruments.

Examination - how far did change follow? ANALYSIS: Enactment, notification, enforcement and social transformation are four distinct stages. The 1989 Act, in force 1990, is an enacted penal statute; the Second Backward Classes Commission, appointed 1979 and reporting 1980, recommends rather than enacts; and *Indra Sawhney* (1992) upheld reservation under Article 16(4), directed creamy-layer exclusion and set an ordinary fifty per cent ceiling. None of these establishes that transformation occurred, and none of them shows that a philosophical justification is correct.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: He secured what conscience could not compel - enforceable claim, autonomous voice and a public standard against inherited authority - and reservation addresses access to positions while annihilation addresses the valuation of persons. Fraternity, which he called indispensable, cannot be legislated and no quota produces it, so the programme remains, by his own diagnosis rather than by external criticism, incomplete.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "State and examine" is scored on the second verb. Most scripts state accurately and then examine nothing, closing with praise. The examination here is supplied by two devices: the four-stage caution, which prevents instruments from being read as outcomes, and the beyond-reservation grid, which shows that the elements he regarded as decisive are precisely those that no instrument can deliver.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: position one line; rights three lines; representation two lines; constitutional morality two lines; social democracy four lines; beyond safeguards three lines; examination four lines; verdict three lines. Compression plan: merge representation into rights before shortening the examination, which is where the second verb is answered.

- **Structure:** position -> rights -> representation -> constitutional morality -> social democracy -> beyond safeguards -> examination -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the argument from social power; constitutional morality; the inseparable triad.
- **Evidence:** Article 17; the 1989 Act in force 1990; *Indra Sawhney* (1992); conversion in 1956.
- **Distinction:** access to positions against the valuation of persons.
- **Criticism:** the four-stage caution; fraternity as the element no safeguard produces.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence stating that his economic proposals aimed at breaking dependence on dominant-caste landowners and employers, because political safeguards do not touch economic dependence and the omission of this element is what makes most scripts read as constitutional summaries. If two further lines are available, note explicitly that the incompleteness identified in the verdict is **his own diagnosis** rather than an external criticism, since that framing converts a concession into an argument about what social democracy requires. Do **not** narrate the Constituent Assembly or expound case law; the instruments are classified illustrations and the philosophical work is done by the programme.

Solved PYQ 4 · 2021 · Q4(a) · 20 marks

Question: Discuss the views of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar regarding caste-discrimination in Indian society. What are the measures suggested by him for its elimination? Explain.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two-part: "Discuss the views" and "What are the measures... Explain" - both halves must be delivered
Core issue	The diagnosis, then the measures that follow from it
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: mechanism, graded inequality, the measures mapped onto links, one limit
Key distinction	Reform of the practice against annihilation of the sanction
Non-negotiables	Measures must follow from the diagnosis, not be listed beside it

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The measures are intelligible only as consequences of the diagnosis, so the two halves must be joined rather than answered in sequence.

The diagnosis. FACT: Caste is an institutional system of **graded inequality** sustained by endogamy, religious authority, social closure and political-economic power. It is a division of **labourers**, not of labour: it ranks persons by birth, ignoring aptitude and restricting association, and subdivides the labouring population into hierarchically graded compartments. Graded inequality - an ascending scale of reverence, a descending scale of contempt - obstructs solidarity, because each level holds a stake in distinction from those below, which is why anti-caste mobilisation has repeatedly failed to unify.

The reproduction mechanism. FACT: In 1916 he identified the **closed marriage circle**: a caste persists only while it does not marry outside, demographic imbalance inside the group threatens that closure, and practices regulating widows, widowers and marriage therefore maintain the boundary. Caste is reproduced through family and sexuality, not occupation alone.

Why limited reform fails. FACT: In 1936 he argued that caste rests on belief in the sacred authority of rules that rank and separate, so isolated reforms leave the normative foundation intact and the hierarchy re-forms around each of them.

The measures, mapped onto the diagnosis. FACT: **Inter-caste marriage** attacks endogamy and creates social kinship; inter-dining alone does not, because a shared meal leaves the marriage circle closed. **Rejection or reconstruction of scriptural authority** attacks the sanction that legitimates rank. **Rights and remedies** independent of dominant goodwill reach enforcement, since a benefit that can be withdrawn is not a right. **Representation** secures autonomous voice against being spoken for. **Constitutional morality** supplies the diffused public commitment without

which a safeguard is inert. **Educate, agitate, organise** builds critical self-respect, public contestation and autonomous collective power, and is a politics of emancipation rather than individual self-help. **Economic independence** breaks dependence on dominant-caste landowners and employers. **Conversion in 1956** places the remedy outside the state altogether.

The limit. ANALYSIS: State competence over religious belief is limited - which is why conversion and constitutional morality are in the programme rather than additions to it.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The measures are not a menu but a set matched to the links that reproduce caste; reservation addresses access to positions while annihilation addresses the valuation of persons, and safeguards without constitutional morality, fraternity and economic independence remain formal.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a two-part stem is scored on the **join**. Scripts that give a diagnosis and then a list of measures have written two half-answers. Mapping each measure onto the mechanism it reaches - marriage circle, sanction, enforcement, voice, capacity, dependence - supplies the connective tissue and simultaneously demonstrates why no single measure was expected to suffice.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: position one line; diagnosis five lines; mechanism three lines; why reform fails two lines; measures seven lines; limit two lines; verdict two lines. Compression plan: reduce the measures to four, keeping marriage, sanction, representation and economic independence, before shortening the diagnosis.

- **Structure:** position -> diagnosis -> mechanism -> why limited reform fails -> measures mapped -> limit -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** graded inequality; division of labourers; endogamy; the sanctified belief-system.
- **Evidence:** "Castes in India" (1916); *Annihilation of Caste* (1936); conversion in 1956.
- **Distinction:** inter-dining against inter-caste marriage; access to positions against valuation of persons.
- **Criticism:** the limit of state competence over belief.

How to improve this answer

Add one clause to the graded-inequality sentence explaining that this is why anti-caste mobilisation repeatedly failed to unify, because the concept then does explanatory work rather than sitting as a definition. If two more lines are available, state the beyond-reservation thesis explicitly - that safeguards without constitutional morality, fraternity and economic independence remain formal - since the examiner is looking for evidence that the candidate knows reservation is a safeguard inside the programme. Do **not** expound Buddhist doctrine after naming the conversion; identify it as an ethical reconstruction around reason, compassion, equality and fraternity, and stop.

Solved PYQ 5 · 2022 · Q1(b) · 10 marks

Question: In the age of individualism and universal franchise, what role does caste play in body-politic? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Discuss" - exposition plus one adjudicated tension
Core issue	What the franchise changes and what it leaves standing
Scope boundary	Ten marks: the tension, the normative separation, the contradiction
Key distinction	Assertion seeking equality against supremacy seeking inherited privilege
Non-negotiables	No electoral description; no data; no condemnation of oppressed-caste organisation

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: Caste's role is neither residual nor unchanged: the franchise transforms it into a resource usable for opposite normative purposes.

What the franchise enables. FACT: It converts subordinated populations into political **constituencies**, making voice, bargaining and policy attention available, and allowing organisation to convert scattered suffering into representation.

What it does not dissolve. ANALYSIS: Caste persists through candidate selection, patronage, symbolic mobilisation and social blocs. The franchise addresses the **citizen** at the ballot; endogamy, ritual rank and material dependence address the **household** continuously. Individualism as a premise does not reach a structure that reproduces through marriage and kinship.

The separation that decides the answer. FACT: **Assertion** seeks equality, voice and equal citizenship and is defensible; **supremacy** seeks inherited privilege and is not; ordinary electoral mobilisation contains elements of both and must be judged by **programme and effect**, never by the mere presence of caste in politics.

The contradiction. FACT: One person one vote and one vote one value, set against a social order of graded worth, is a contradiction a polity cannot indefinitely bear. ANALYSIS: This is a diagnosis of instability, not a prediction.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Caste's role is ambivalent by construction: it is simultaneously the instrument through which the excluded claim equal standing and the channel through which precedence is preserved, and only the programme distinguishes them.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: this stem attracts two opposite failures - celebrating democratic caste mobilisation and condemning all of it. The three-way separation is what lets a script adjudicate instead, and the contradiction between equal votes and graded worth supplies a conclusion that is analytical rather than aspirational. Electoral description earns nothing here.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: position one line; what the franchise enables two lines; what it does not dissolve four lines; the separation four lines; contradiction two lines; verdict two lines. Compression plan: shorten the enabling paragraph, never the separation, which is the answer.

- **Structure:** position -> enabled -> not dissolved -> the three-way separation -> contradiction -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** franchise as constituency-formation; political against social democracy.
- **Evidence:** candidate selection, patronage, symbolic mobilisation, social blocs; the citizen/household contrast.
- **Distinction:** assertion, supremacy and mixed mobilisation judged by programme and effect.
- **Criticism:** the conceded residues of elite capture and permanent bloc politics.

How to improve this answer

Add one clause conceding elite capture and permanent bloc politics as residues within assertion itself, because an answer that presents assertion as automatically emancipatory has ignored a risk the source itself names. If two more lines are available, note that "individualism" in the stem is a premise about the citizen and cannot by itself reach marriage, kinship and dependence - a point most scripts leave implicit and which directly addresses the stem's own framing. Do **not** assert anything about voting patterns, party behaviour or the electoral strength of any group; no such claim is available in this package.

Solved PYQ 6 · 2022 · Q2(b) · 15 marks

Question: Critically evaluate Gandhi's views on eradication of caste discrimination.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically evaluate" - the objection-reply-residue layer is the answer
Core issue	What Gandhi's method reaches and what it cannot secure
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: periodisation, method, two full chains, differentiated verdict
Key distinction	Reform of the practice against annihilation of the sanction
Non-negotiables	State the achievement before the criticism; give each objection at full strength

Independent model answer

Periodisation first. FACT: Gandhi condemned untouchability throughout; earlier he defended an idealised hereditary duty-order as duties without rank; later he opposed birth barriers and supported inter-caste marriage. ANALYSIS: The trajectory is reconstructed across decades, not dated.

The view. FACT: Untouchability is a moral and religious wrong incompatible with truth, non-violence and equal spiritual worth. Inherited exclusion corrupts both the excluded and the excluding conscience, so reform requires repentance and changed conduct by the privileged. Legal prohibition is necessary and cannot generate fellowship.

The method, stated fairly. FACT: Six instruments: self-purification, truth-force, the constructive programme of education, sanitation and common service, religious reinterpretation from within, non-violent persuasion, and trusteeship with economic reform. His achievement was to bring caste humiliation into mass moral discourse and make privileged responsibility central.

Chain one - the structural objection. FACT: Change of heart leaves property, office and institutional exclusion intact. **Reply:** the constructive programme and truth-force are social practices, not private sentiment. ANALYSIS: **Residue:** enforceable rights are still required, and a justice depending on benevolence remains revocable.

Chain two - the duty-order objection. FACT: Hereditary duty reproduces caste even where superiority is denied. **Reply:** the later trajectory weakens birth hierarchy. ANALYSIS: **Residue:** the early defences remain a theoretical liability that chronology cannot cancel.

Differentiated verdict. ANALYSIS: The replies succeed unequally. The "mere sentiment" charge fails, because shared service and truth-force are social practices; the duty-order reply partially succeeds, because the later position is genuinely different; the paternalism reply establishes that the responsibility of oppressors cannot be delegated without establishing that responsibility alone suffices; and the structural objection survives essentially intact. Gandhi's method is therefore **insufficient rather than mistaken**, and its insufficiency is located precisely at rights and representation.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: "Critically evaluate" is not "list the criticisms". Two chains worked to a residue outperform six criticisms named, because only the residue requires judgment. The differentiated verdict - four replies succeeding to different degrees - is what separates assessment from balance, and it is the single feature examiners most often find missing.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: periodisation three lines; the view three lines; method and achievement four lines; chain one three lines; chain two three lines; verdict three lines. Compression plan: reduce the method to three instruments before dropping either chain, since the chains carry the directive.

- **Structure:** periodisation -> the view -> method and achievement -> objection chain -> objection chain -> differentiated verdict.
- **Doctrine:** two-way corruption; law necessary and insufficient; means embodying ends.
- **Evidence:** the six instruments; the constructive programme; the later support for inter-caste marriage.
- **Distinction:** insufficiency against error; social practice against private sentiment.
- **Criticism:** revocability of benevolent justice; the surviving duty-order liability.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence naming the link each instrument reaches - shared service attacks the rule that certain labour pollutes, trusteeship attacks dependence, and neither reaches the sanction - because a targeted evaluation is more precise than any general verdict on efficacy. If a further line is available, state the paternalism residue in its conditional form: the objection stands **unless** oppressed communities possess autonomous voice and leadership, which converts a moral complaint into a testable condition. Do **not** open with the criticism; a critical evaluation that never states what the position secured reads as denunciation and forfeits the balance the directive requires.

Solved PYQ 7 · 2023 · Q3(b) · 15 marks

Question: Critically analyse the social and political significance of Ambedkar's notion of annihilation of caste.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Critically analyse" the significance , split into two named dimensions
Core issue	What annihilation means, and what it achieves socially and politically
Scope boundary	Fifteen marks: the target, the two significances, one objection with reply, verdict
Key distinction	Destroying the sanction against reforming the practice
Non-negotiables	Both halves - social and political - must be separately delivered

Independent model answer

What annihilation means. FACT: Not the removal of caste feeling by exhortation, and not the abolition of cultural difference. Caste is sustained by belief in the **sacred authority of rules that rank and separate**; isolated reforms leave that foundation intact; inter-dining does not open the marriage circle; inter-caste marriage attacks endogamy and creates social kinship; and annihilation requires rejection or radical reconstruction of scriptural authority, social rights and material relations.

Social significance. FACT: It relocates the target from practices to the **marriage circle** and to the valuation of persons. Caste is ranked separation, not plurality: it fragments society into unequal, mutually closed groups, destroys fraternity, and denies free choice of occupation and association. Annihilation therefore aims at association and worth, not at etiquette.

Political significance. FACT: Because caste narrows loyalty and obstructs public spirit, it disables the disposition to common action on which public life depends. A political democracy resting on graded social worth is unstable - one person one vote and one vote one value against unequal worth. Annihilation is thus a condition of social democracy, not a supplement to it.

Objection. FACT: The argument proves too much: if the sanction is sacred, nothing short of dismantling a religious tradition can help. **Reply:** ANALYSIS: the fifth move names authority, rights **and** material relations together; rights and material relations are alterable politically, and the claim is about **insufficiency**, not impossibility.

Residual limit. CAUTION: How the sanction is dislodged where conversion is not chosen remains underspecified, and state competence over belief is limited.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Its significance is that it reclassifies caste from a set of objectionable practices into a legitimated order of worth - which is why reform of the practice had repeatedly left the allocation intact.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: the stem names two dimensions, and scripts routinely deliver one. Writing "social significance" and "political significance" as separate labelled moves guarantees both halves are visible, and the inter-dining/inter-marriage discrimination supplies the concrete content that distinguishes analysis from paraphrase.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 330 words: meaning five lines; social significance four lines; political significance four lines; objection and reply three lines; residual limit one line; verdict two lines. Compression plan: shorten the meaning paragraph to the sanction claim and the marriage point, never the two significance paragraphs.

- **Structure:** what it means -> social significance -> political significance -> objection and reply -> residue -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the sanctified belief-system; ranked separation against plurality; social democracy.
- **Evidence:** *Annihilation of Caste* (1936); the inter-dining/inter-marriage discrimination; the one-vote-one-value contradiction.
- **Distinction:** destroying the sanction against reforming the practice.
- **Criticism:** the proves-too-much objection, met by the insufficiency reading.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence connecting the 1936 proposals to the 1916 identification of endogamy, because without that link the measures look like an unordered list rather than a consequence of the mechanism. If two further lines are available, state explicitly that caste is not diversity but ranked separation, and give the two-part test - is the difference ranked, is association across it free - since this is what protects the argument from the objection that it is hostile to cultural difference. Do **not** treat annihilation as a synonym for social harmony; the word names the destruction of an authority, and softening it forfeits both halves of the stem.

Solved PYQ 8 · 2024 · Q1(c) · 10 marks

Question: Discuss the main factors responsible for caste discrimination.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Discuss the main factors" - a causal account, not an inventory
Core issue	What reproduces caste discrimination
Scope boundary	Ten marks: precise definition, the chain, the consequence, a qualified verdict
Key distinction	Division of labour against division of labourers
Non-negotiables	Chain form, not a list; mark the ambivalence of political mobilisation

Independent model answer

Define precisely. FACT: Caste discrimination is graded, birth-based social closure sustained by a **closed marriage circle** - not "social stratification", and not a division of labour.

The factors, as a chain. FACT: **Endogamy** closes the group and carries membership across generations.

Hereditary status assigns social worth by birth, before any act or aptitude. **Occupational closure** allocates work by birth-group and stigmatises the labour itself. **Purity and pollution** rules moralise distance, so exclusion is experienced as duty, and **religious sanction** presents hierarchy as sacred. **Social and economic power** - land, employment and dependence - enforces the norm. **ANALYSIS: Political mobilisation** is ambivalent: it can democratise subordinated groups and can harden competitive identities.

Why the chain form matters. FACT: Each link makes the next possible, so the system **absorbs the reform of any single component**: prohibiting the ritual practice leaves the marriage circle, and opening the occupation leaves the sanction. Inter-caste marriage reaches the first link; reservation the third.

The consequence. FACT: The result is **graded inequality** - an ascending scale of reverence and a descending scale of contempt - which obstructs solidarity, because each level holds a stake in distinction from below.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: The main factor is the linkage rather than any one item: caste is a division of labourers rather than of labour, and abolishing it means attacking the marriage circle and the sanction together with the dependence enforcing them.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: a factors stem is where lists are most tempting and least rewarded. Six accurate nouns describe; a chain explains. The absorption property is the mark-bearing sentence, because it converts the account into a prediction that can be tested against any proposed remedy - which is exactly what the surrounding parts of the paper go on to ask.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 220 words: definition two lines; chain seven lines; why the chain matters three lines; consequence two lines; verdict two lines. Compression plan: merge purity and sanction into one line before shortening the absorption sentence, which carries the analysis.

- **Structure:** precise definition -> the seven-link chain -> absorption property -> graded inequality -> verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the reproduction engine; division of labourers; graded inequality.
- **Evidence:** endogamy, hereditary status, occupational closure, ritual rules, sanction, dependence.
- **Distinction:** allocation of tasks against ranking of persons.
- **Criticism:** the ambivalence of mobilisation; single-component reform absorbed.

How to improve this answer

Add one clause mapping two remedies onto their links - inter-caste marriage reaches endogamy, reservation reaches occupational closure - because it demonstrates that the chain is an analytical instrument and not a description, and it takes only a line. If a further line is available, note that this is a **reproduction** account rather than a genesis account, which forestalls a historical objection without inviting a dispute the paper does not require. Do **not** slide into an exploitation narrative: caste interacts with class without being reducible to it, and the reduction forfeits the ranking claim on which the whole answer rests.

Solved PYQ 9 · 2025 · Q2(a) · 20 marks

Question: Present a detailed account of the debate between Gandhi and Ambedkar on the issue of caste discrimination.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	"Present a detailed account of the debate" - the disagreement is the object, not the two thinkers
Core issue	On which axes they differ, and what follows
Scope boundary	Twenty marks: five or six axes run in parallel, convergence, the 1932 test, adjudication
Key distinction	Reform of the practice against annihilation of the sanction
Non-negotiables	No two sequential biographies; no equal division of credit

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The debate is a disagreement about the **object** of reform, and it must be displayed on shared axes.

Axis one - the primary evil. FACT: For Gandhi, untouchability and moral degradation, and later the wider birth barriers; for Ambedkar, caste itself as graded inequality, an ascending scale of reverence and a descending scale of contempt.

Axis two - the hereditary duty-order. FACT: Gandhi earlier defended an idealised duty-order as duties without rank, and moved later towards opposing birth barriers and supporting inter-caste marriage; Ambedkar holds birth-based division intrinsically unjust throughout. ANALYSIS: The residue is that inherited allocation survives the denial of rank.

Axis three - the root mechanism. FACT: Corrupted religion, prejudice and lost conscience against endogamy, scriptural sanction, social closure and power - which is why Gandhi's remedy begins with conduct and Ambedkar's with the marriage circle and the authority that legitimates rank.

Axis four - the agent. FACT: The transformed conscience of the privileged, with oppressed participation, against the **autonomous** organisation and representation of the oppressed themselves.

Axis five - method. FACT: Self-purification, truth-force, constructive work of education, sanitation and common service, and reform from within, against rights, law, education, organisation, representation and inter-caste marriage.

Axis six - religion and democracy. FACT: Reform from within and ethical fellowship in self-rule, against rejection of caste-sanctioning authority, conversion in **1956**, constitutional morality and social democracy.

The 1932 test case. ANALYSIS: The Communal Award provided separate electoral arrangements; Gandhi opposed them and fasted; the Poona Pact substituted reserved seats in joint electorates with a primary-election mechanism and increased reserved seats. The question was **who may choose a subordinated group's representatives**, and the settlement was reached under coercive circumstances.

Convergence. FACT: Both hold untouchability indefensible, affirm equal worth, regard political freedom without social reform as incomplete, and reject violence as a foundation.

Adjudication. ANALYSIS: Convergence identifies common ends and does not equalise diagnostic adequacy. Ambedkar's account explains what Gandhi's cannot: why the hierarchy survives every reform of its outward practice. Gandhi nonetheless secures what Ambedkar's method cannot compel - the responsibility of the privileged, the identity of means and ends, and the insistence that law must enter social character - and Ambedkar himself holds safeguards without fraternity to remain formal. The defensible position is therefore **Ambedkarite in structure and rights, Gandhian only where moral transformation serves - never substitutes for - annihilation.**

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus: this is the stem on which the two-biography structure costs most, because a "detailed account of the debate" is marked on whether the disagreement is visible. Labelled axes make it visible in the layout itself, and the 1932 episode earns its place only as the point where the axes produce incompatible answers rather than as narrative.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 330 to 400 words: position one line; six axes ten lines; the 1932 test case four lines; convergence two lines; adjudication four lines. Compression plan: merge axes three and five before dropping the adjudication, which the directive requires.

- **Structure:** position -> six labelled axes -> 1932 test case -> convergence -> adjudication.
- **Doctrine:** the comparison matrix; convergence without false equivalence.
- **Evidence:** the 1932 Communal Award and Poona Pact, interpreted; conversion in 1956.
- **Distinction:** reform of the practice against annihilation of the sanction.
- **Criticism:** paternalism and structural insufficiency against legalism and the limits of state action.

How to improve this answer

Add one sentence stating what Gandhi secured that Ambedkar's method cannot compel - the responsibility of the privileged, the identity of means and ends, and the insistence that law must enter social character - because an adjudication that concedes nothing reads as advocacy rather than judgment. If two further lines are available, note that Ambedkar himself holds safeguards without fraternity to remain formal, which shows the concession is internal to his position rather than a courtesy extended to his opponent. Do **not** assert figures, negotiating detail or an account of the fast beyond the sequence stated; the philosophical content lies entirely in the principle at stake.

ANALYSIS: These six originals are constructed to cover the parts of the owned clause that the 2018-2025 corpus has **not** yet examined directly, so that preparation is not confined to the nine questions already asked. They test the conceptual grammar and the four-term separation, the division-of-labourers argument against the functional defence, the four dimensions of caste injustice, the place of fraternity in the triad, the village-and-modernity dispute, and the four justifications of affirmative action with the reverse-discrimination objection.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 1 · 10 marks · about 150 to 220 words

Question: "Untouchability is a symptom of caste, not a synonym for it." Examine the significance of this distinction.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The distinction is not terminological housekeeping; it decides what a remedy must reach.

The four terms. FACT: The textual fourfold order is a normative classification and is not identical with the lived order; the lived birth-group is a locally organised, generally endogamous group, of which there are thousands with wide regional variation; the caste system is the institutional order joining birth, marriage closure, ranked status, allocated occupation and restricted association; and untouchability names practices imposing extreme exclusion and stigma on designated groups.

Why untouchability is a symptom. FACT: The ranking principle - that birth fixes worth - operates throughout the order. Untouchability is its most extreme expression, so a rule abolishing the practice can succeed while birth continues to allocate marriage, occupation and standing everywhere else.

The doctrinal consequence. FACT: This is why Ambedkar holds that untouchability cannot be eliminated without annihilating caste, and why reform limited to the practice is rejected as insufficient.

The evaluative consequence. ANALYSIS: It also fixes the terms of the Gandhi-Ambedkar dispute: a position can condemn untouchability without opposing an idealised duty-order that still allocates by birth.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Merging the terms makes both positions unstable and converts a structural argument into a moral one.

Original 2 · 10 marks · about 150 to 220 words

Question: Is caste best understood as a division of labour? Give reasons for your answer.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: No - and stating **why** requires a distinction rather than a denial.

The defence, at its strongest. FACT: Every complex society divides work; specialisation is efficient; caste was the traditional Indian form of that division, so condemning it appears to condemn specialisation itself.

The decisive distinction. FACT: A division of **labour** allocates tasks and permits entry, exit and judgment by aptitude, leaving the worker's standing untouched. A division of **labourers** allocates and ranks persons: it fixes occupation by birth, ignores aptitude and choice, subdivides the labouring population into hierarchically graded compartments, and requires a closed marriage circle to keep them distinct.

Three supporting moves. FACT: Efficiency cannot license ascription, and an allocation ignoring aptitude is not efficient on its own terms; the ranking is of persons, which no functional account of tasks requires; and stigma attaches to the labour **because of who performs it**, so the hierarchy rather than the division produces the degradation.

The conceded limit. ANALYSIS: The argument does not reach the ritual and purity dimension, so used alone it yields an economic reading that cannot explain why exclusion feels obligatory.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Caste is a hereditary ranking of workers, and must be paired with graded inequality and the sanction.

Original 3 · 15 marks · about 250 to 330 words

Question: Examine the claim that remedies for caste injustice must satisfy redistribution, recognition and representation together.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The claim is defensible as a statement of **non-substitutability** and overstated if read as a claim about priority.

The four dimensions. FACT: Redistribution answers unequal land, labour, education, networks and security, and requires resources and institutional access. Recognition answers stigma, purity and pollution, humiliation and graded worth, and requires the repudiation of inherited rank. Representation answers the condition in which others speak for a group and control candidate and office access, and requires autonomous voice and political safeguards. Religion answers hierarchy presented as sacred authority, and requires freedom of conscience together with the rejection of civic disability.

Why they are not substitutes. FACT: Each names a distinct mechanism, so a remedy succeeding in one can leave the others intact. **Identity without redistribution** leaves material power exactly where it was; **redistribution without recognition** transfers resources while preserving humiliation. Both failures are observable in principle and neither is describable if the dimensions are merged.

The two mediating axes. FACT: Endogamy makes caste continuity depend on regulating women's marriage and sexuality, so caste and gender are **jointly structured** rather than arithmetically added; and caste interacts with control of land, labour and education without being reducible to class, since no account of ownership supplies the sacred sanction.

The objection. FACT: The grid multiplies categories: all four are ultimately about power, so dividing power into four components describes one domination four times. **Reply:** ANALYSIS: the division earns its keep by predicting failure, which an undifferentiated concept of power cannot state.

The residual limit. CAUTION: The grid establishes no **priority**; whether recognition must precede redistribution is contested and unresolved here.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Together, yes - as a completeness test on any proposed remedy, not as a sequence.

Original 4 · 15 marks · about 250 to 330 words

Question: "Fraternity is the least attended and most necessary of Ambedkar's three principles." Critically discuss.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The claim is correct about necessity and requires care about what fraternity is.

The triad as a structure. FACT: Liberty without equality permits domination by the already powerful; equality without liberty suppresses individuality; both without fraternity lack the social disposition to recognise others as equals at all. The three are not parallel goods but mutual conditions.

What fraternity names. FACT: Not sentimentality or goodwill, but the **social basis of democracy** - a sense of common associated life among social equals, supported by rights and institutions. It is therefore not the alternative to rights but what rights require in order to function.

Why it is most necessary here. FACT: Caste is ranked separation: it narrows loyalty to the birth-group and obstructs public spirit, so the disposition to common action among persons who do not know one another is exactly what the order withdraws. FACT: A political democracy resting on graded social worth is unstable - one person one vote and one vote one value against unequal worth - and the instability is a deficit of fraternity, not of procedure.

The objection. FACT: The concept is too vague to do this work: if it cannot be legislated or measured, any failure can be attributed to its absence and any success to its presence. **Reply:** ANALYSIS: it is testable where caste operates - whether association across the boundary is free, and whether common action extends beyond the birth-group.

The residual limit. CAUTION: Cultivation remains unspecified: no quota produces fraternity, and the owner does not say how it is produced.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: It is most necessary precisely because it is the element no safeguard delivers - which is why safeguards without it remain formal.

Original 5 · 20 marks · about 330 to 400 words

Question: "Neither the village nor centralised modernity is inherently emancipatory for caste." Examine this claim with reference to Gandhi and Ambedkar.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: The claim is correct, and its force lies in replacing a contrast of eras with a **test**.

The two positions. FACT: Gandhi treats decentralised community as a possible school of responsibility, meaningful labour and self-rule: it is where conduct is enacted daily, and his constructive programme of education, sanitation and common service presupposes exactly that setting. FACT: Ambedkar warns that the **actually existing** village can concentrate caste authority, dependency and exclusion - precisely because face-to-face dependence makes exit costly and observation constant.

Why this is not tradition against modernity. ANALYSIS: The disagreement is not about eras. Centralised modern institutions can reproduce caste through recruitment, networks and the informal transmission of standing; local community can reproduce it through dependence and surveillance. Neither scale carries emancipation as a property.

The test that replaces the contrast. FACT: Ask whether scale, technology and community enlarge **mobility, equal status, constitutional rights** and **exit from inherited occupation**. That test is applied to both, and it is what makes the claim examinable rather than rhetorical.

Running the test. ANALYSIS: Gandhi's setting scores on shared practice, since common service attacks the ritual rule that certain labour pollutes those who perform it; it scores poorly on exit, because dependence is unchanged and there is nowhere to go. Ambedkar's institutional route scores on rights and exit, since a benefit that can be withdrawn is not a right and representation supplies voice; it scores poorly on everyday relations, which is why he insists that constitutional morality and fraternity must accompany the machinery.

Objection and reply. FACT: The test is impossible to apply, since mobility and status are not measurable. **Reply:** ANALYSIS: it is applied comparatively rather than absolutely - whether an arrangement enlarges or contracts each of the four - and the owner asserts no measurement of any Indian case.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Neither scale is emancipatory without anti-caste power. The village is not condemned as such and modernity is not credited as such; what decides is whether either arrangement opens the marriage circle, dissolves dependence and secures rights that do not depend on goodwill.

Original 6 · 20 marks · about 330 to 400 words

Question: On what ground, if any, is affirmative action for historically excluded castes justified? Meet the strongest objection to your position.

Independent model answer

Position. ANALYSIS: Name the ground first. Mine is **compensatory in ground, distributive in mechanism, representational in institutional justification, and anti-domination in ultimate aim** - and the join must be stated, because the four grounds have different premises and different termination conditions.

The compensatory argument, reconstructed. FACT: Caste exclusion was systematic, institutional and for long periods sanctioned by religious authority and by law; it was **group-directed**, operating on persons by reason of birth-membership rather than conduct; its effects are transmitted through inherited wealth, land, occupation, schooling, language, networks and social confidence; removing the formal bar from today therefore ratifies those results as though they were the outcome of fair competition; and a remedy must reach the transmission mechanism and must be group-directed because the disadvantage is. ANALYSIS: The presupposition - that institutionally caused disadvantage can be traced reliably enough to justify a group-directed remedy - must be argued, not assumed.

Ambedkar's stronger framing. ANALYSIS: On his diagnosis caste is **graded inequality**, an ascending scale of reverence and descending scale of contempt, so the wrong is a hierarchy of **worth** rather than a distributive shortfall - which is why his argument runs through representation and power rather than welfare.

The strongest objection. FACT: Persons must be treated as individuals; selection should track qualification; reservation allocates by ascriptive membership; the excluded individual is personally innocent; so a fresh injustice is inflicted, reproducing allocation by birth-group.

The reply, in four moves. ANALYSIS: **Symmetry:** the unreserved baseline is not neutral, since qualifications are themselves unequally producible. **Merit as proxy:** merit is functional capacity for the role and examination performance is a proxy whose reliability varies with coaching, nutrition, language and schooling - refining the proxy pursues merit more accurately rather than abandoning it. **Advantage, not guilt:** no culpability is attributed; the claim is that some are unjustly advantaged by a continuing distribution. **Group harm, group remedy:** a group-transmitted

disadvantage cannot be reached individually.

The conceded residue. ANALYSIS: Over-inclusion of the already advantaged, which the creamy-layer filter addresses at the cost of weakening the representational ground; and cost falling unevenly near the margin.

Verdict. ANALYSIS: Justified on the stated join; the objection is answered but not eliminated, and saying so is stronger than pretending otherwise.